

THE MOVE

Purpose -> context -> ask -> reply path -> deadline or next step. -> Minimum viable move: "Quick ask: can you approve the revised copy? Only the headline changed. Reply approve or edit by Thursday noon; I'll handle the update." -> Full field ?

START HERE

State the purpose, give one context line, make one clear ask, and add an easy reply path.

SAY THIS

Quick asks & openers	<i>"Quick ask: can you approve the revised headline by 2 pm?"</i>
Work requests & upd...	<i>"Quick ask: can you confirm whether option A is acceptable? It keeps the launch date unchanged. A yes/no by 2 pm is enough."</i>
Decisions & reply pat...	<i>"Decision needed by 3 pm: A keep Friday launch with reduced scope, or B move to Tuesday with full scope. Reply A or B."</i>
Context & warmth lines	<i>"The only context you need is that the deadline moved from Tuesday to Friday."</i>
Autonomy & recovery	<i>"No pressure if this isn't the right week; a quick no is helpful too."</i>
Escalation & pressure	<i>"Decision needed: pause the launch, or proceed with known risk. My recommendation is pause - detail below."</i>

AVOID

- The issue needs substantial evidence, legal or clinical detail, or careful documentation
- The moment calls for emotional repair or a consent-sensitive decision
- The other person has asked for depth, or brevity would feel dismissive given the power dynamic

REMEMBER

Write for the one screen they'll actually read.